



Investigation report

Rejected take-off and runway overrun, Tarlton Springs - Standard investigation

Drafted 28/09/2026

INVESTIGATION WORKFLOW SUITE

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Executive summary

On 18 June 2026, Saltbush Air flight SB512, a 50-seat twin-turboprop registered VH-SBQ, rejected its take-off from runway 09 at Tarlton Springs Aerodrome at about 17:30 local time after two kangaroos crossed onto the runway. On board were 44 passengers, two flight crew and one cabin crew member. The captain began the rejected take-off at 118 kt, 6 kt above V1, and the aircraft struck both animals one second later. It left the sealed runway at approximately 21 kt at 07:30:51 UTC. It stopped upright on the extended centreline, 62 m into the 90 m runway end safety area and 28 m short of its end, beyond which the terrain is ungraded.

No one was seriously injured. One cabin crew member reported bruising during the disembarkation. Both kangaroos were killed, and the aerodrome was closed for 4 hours 20 minutes. The aircraft was substantially damaged:

- three No. 2 propeller blades were damaged beyond limits, and the engine needed a shock-load inspection
- the right main gear doors were distorted
- both right main tyres deflated through their fuse plugs after the brakes absorbed 84% of their certified energy
- the lower right fuselage was punctured

Why the aircraft overran

The scheduled accelerate-stop distance left a margin of only 67 m, assuming a stop begun at or before V1 with reverse thrust on both engines. Instead, the reject began 6 kt late with 695 m of runway remaining. The strike destroyed the No. 2 propeller, leaving reverse thrust on No. 1 only. Mean deceleration was approximately 15% below the certified value, and the aircraft needed 757 m to stop. Neither the late start nor the reduced deceleration alone would have taken the aircraft past the runway end.

It is very likely that the kangaroos entered through the northern perimeter fence. The fence was recorded as failed, with animals passing through, in April 2023, and its repair was deferred unfunded at three successive budget rounds. An animal pad through the fence lay on the same side of the runway as the carcasses, and upstream of them.

The departure was in darkness, 5 minutes after the end of civil twilight. The aerodrome's sighting log recorded 38 of its 41 kangaroo entries in this period. No runway inspection was requested, although the aerodrome would have carried one out if asked.

Safety issues

Five safety issues contributed:

- **Runway inspection listing criterion.** The operator's manual required a runway inspection before the first departure after last light only at aerodromes listed in Appendix 8A. The only way onto that list was a reported wildlife strike there, so the control could be triggered only by the event it existed to prevent. Eleven sightings of kangaroos on the sealed surface could not list Tarlton Springs.
- **Introduction of the evening service.** It was approved as a schedule change only, without reopening the Tarlton Springs route risk assessment, which restricted operations to daylight.
- **Rejected take-off training.** Training and procedures addressed only aircraft system failures, with no guidance on a runway obstruction at any speed. The captain stated that he rejected knowingly, judging continuing the greater risk. On that reading the gap is a

fleet-wide deficiency rather than the cause of this decision. The investigation found it likely to have contributed, and presents both readings.

- **Fence repair deferral.** The repair was deferred for three budget cycles.
- **Aerodrome standard threshold.** AS-139 requires a documented wildlife hazard management plan only above a size threshold Tarlton Springs does not meet; the aerodrome was not in breach. The investigation found it likely that this contributed. This finding is less certain than the others, because a documented plan would not necessarily have secured funding for the fence repair.

Other safety findings

A sixth safety issue did not contribute. Two floor proximity escape path lighting segments in the aft cabin were dark because of a failed ballast. The pre-flight test cannot detect this defect, and the same ballast is fitted across the type.

The flight was the crew's fifth sector, 11 hours into their duty. The recorded data did not show this affected their performance, but it is a standing exposure built into the schedule.

The runway edge lighting was measured seven days later at above nominal intensity. The investigation could not determine whether it affected detection of the animals.

Once the decision was made, maximum braking and No. 1 reverse were applied faster than the fleet average. A tailwind and a loss of power on the No. 2 engine were excluded.

Safety action

The Head of Flying Operations suspended the evening Tarlton Springs service. [NOT ESTABLISHED: safety actions taken or recommended in response to each safety issue]

Event overview

On 18 June 2026, Saltbush Air flight SB512 was scheduled to depart Tarlton Springs Aerodrome for Sydney on the last scheduled sector of the day. The aircraft, VH-SBQ, was a 50-seat twin-turboprop carrying 44 passengers, two flight crew and one cabin crew member.

SB512 was the fifth sector of the flight crew's duty. It had been added to their roster that morning, when the originally rostered crew reported unfit. The crew had signed on at 06:30 local. The planned duty was 12 hours 05 minutes, against a maximum of 12 hours 30 minutes permitted for five sectors with that sign-on time.

- **Captain:** 8,410 hours total, including 2,140 hours on type, with 3 years 1 month in command.
- **First officer:** 1,655 hours total, including 405 hours on type, with 14 months at the operator. Her two previous sectors into Tarlton Springs had both been flown in daylight.

The first officer was the pilot flying.

Before the flight

The aerodrome operator's daily movement area inspection at 07:35 local (21:35 UTC on 17 June), before the first scheduled arrival, recorded the movement area as clear. It was the only runway inspection of the day; no further inspection was carried out or requested.

SB512 closed its doors at 07:16 UTC, 40 minutes behind schedule, by which time the aerodrome was in darkness. [NOT ESTABLISHED: time of last light or end of civil twilight at Tarlton Springs on 18/06/2026, relative to the departure]. The tower was open and rostered to close at 18:00 local.

The take-off was planned for runway 09, which was dry, with flap 10, a weight of 20,800 kg and a 5 kt headwind component. The calculated V1 was 112 kt.

Take-off clearance

At 07:29:04 the captain reported ready for runway 09. At 07:29:10 the tower cleared the aircraft: "Saltbush five one two, wind zero nine zero at six, runway zero nine, cleared for take-off." The tower did not offer a runway inspection and the crew did not request one. No transmission about wildlife was made on the tower channel in the preceding 90 minutes.

The captain handed over with "Your aeroplane, your take-off". The first officer confirmed she had control and called "Power set" at 07:30:02.

The take-off roll

Flight data showed normal engine behaviour throughout the roll. Both engines reached take-off torque, at 98.4% and 98.5%, and stayed within 0.1% of each other until the power levers were retarded. No caution, warning or parameter exceedance was recorded, and none was active at the captain's "Eighty knots" call at 07:30:15. The recorded headwind component was 4 to 6 kt throughout, with no tailwind at any point.

At 07:30:29 the captain called "V one" at 112 kt. He later said on the flight deck that after V1 he had been "heads-in on the engine page".

The kangaroos and the rejected take-off

At 07:30:31, at 116 kt, the first officer called "Roos - roos, roos, on the left, they're on the -". Two kangaroos were crossing the runway from north to south. She estimated the range at first sight at around 200 m.

The sources describe the animals' position when first seen in slightly different terms:

- The occurrence notification recorded them moving onto the runway from the northern side, past the 1,100 m point.
- After the aircraft stopped, the first officer told the captain the animals had "came out of the dark on the left of the strip, crossed the centreline", and that she "had them for - I don't know, two seconds. Maybe less."
- The captain's safety report described them as already on the sealed surface when he looked up.
- After the aircraft stopped, the captain said: "I never had them."

At 07:30:32 the captain called "Stopping. I have control", and the first officer handed over. The aircraft was at 118 kt, 6 kt and 3 seconds past V1, and 1,152 m along runway 09 with 695 m of sealed surface remaining. Both power levers reached flight idle within 0.6 seconds.

The strike

At 07:30:33 the aircraft struck both animals at 114 kt. Flight data recorded a lateral acceleration spike of 0.31 g to the right and a vertical spike of 1.48 g. The cockpit voice recorder captured a sound consistent with a heavy impact, lasting about 0.4 seconds, followed by airframe rumble. The first officer's next call was partly unintelligible but included "took one on the prop."

The right main landing gear and the No. 2 propeller took the impact, and No. 2 propeller RPM began to decay from that moment.

The stop

Maximum braking, at 2,940 psi, was established at 07:30:34, two seconds after the decision to reject, at the fast end of the operator's recorded fleet distribution (mean 3.2 seconds). Anti-skid was active on all four wheels.

At 07:30:36 the captain called "Reverse - number two's not coming. Max brakes, max brakes." Reverse was obtained on the No. 1 engine only; the No. 2 reverse interlock did not make.

Between 07:30:34 and 07:30:44 the mean deceleration was 2.6 m/s^2 , approximately 15% below the value in the certified accelerate-stop data for this weight and runway condition, which assumes symmetric reverse.

- **07:30:41:** the first officer called the speed decreasing through sixty and fifty.
- **07:30:47:** the captain said "We're not stopping on it."
- **07:30:49:** the first officer called "End's coming up."
- **07:30:51:** the aircraft left the sealed surface at approximately 21 kt.

In the graded gravel of the runway end safety area, deceleration fell to 1.9 m/s^2 . The aircraft stopped at 07:30:57, 62 m into the 90 m runway end safety area, upright and on the extended centreline, with the nose wheel 28 m short of the end of the prepared area, beyond which the terrain is ungraded. From 118 kt, it had needed 757 m to stop.

After the aircraft stopped

At 07:30:59 the captain asked whether everyone was alright, and the first officer confirmed she was. The captain set the parking brake, noted no fire indications and stated "I'm not evacuating"; the first officer agreed nothing was showing. Both fuel levers were moved to cut-off at 07:31:26.

At 07:31:34 the captain told the cabin: "remain seated, remain seated. We have stopped on the aerodrome, there is no fire, stand by."

Asked by the tower for the aircraft's situation, the captain reported the reject and runway excursion off runway 09, 44 passengers and three crew on board, no injuries reported and no fire, and requested activation of the aerodrome emergency plan and a vehicle. At 07:32:10 the tower

activated the plan and dispatched a vehicle; the captain advised no assistance was needed for injuries at that stage.

At 07:33:02 the captain told the cabin that passengers would disembark by the forward door onto the ground, noting that it was dark and gravel outside, "so nice and slow, no rush, no evacuation." A sound consistent with the forward airstair operating was recorded at 07:34:40.

No evacuation was commanded, no slides were deployed, and the main cabin lights remained on. The occurrence notification recorded that passengers were disembarked 4 minutes 8 seconds after the aircraft stopped, whereas the timeline records disembarkation running from 07:34:40 to 07:38:48, a period of 4 minutes 8 seconds beginning after the airstair operated.

Aerodrome staff attended with a vehicle; there was no fire. During disembarkation the first officer noticed unlit sections of the cabin floor proximity strip towards the rear of the cabin. She raised this with an engineer the next morning, and a functional check was carried out on 24 June.

Injuries and damage

There were no serious injuries. One cabin crew member later reported bruising during the disembarkation. Both kangaroos were killed; their carcasses were recovered 1,188 m and 1,221 m from the runway 09 threshold.

The aircraft was substantially damaged:

- **No. 2 propeller:** three blades damaged beyond repairable limits, with leading edge deformation and one blade tip separation. Animal tissue was recovered from two blade roots, and the engine required a shock-load inspection.
- **Right main landing gear:** gear doors distorted by the impact; both right main tyres deflated through their fuse plugs.
- **Brakes:** absorbed 84% of the certified maximum energy for the weight and speed.
- **Fuselage:** lower right skin abrasion and two punctures consistent with propeller debris.

The runway survey found continuous tyre marks from 1,160 m to the runway end, and a nose wheel rut continuing to the stopping point.

Immediate actions

The aerodrome was closed for 4 hours 20 minutes and the aircraft quarantined at Tarlton Springs. Its flight data recorder and cockpit voice recorder were removed at 12:40 UTC and couriered to the operator's flight data section.

Both flight crew were stood down and tested for drugs and alcohol, with negative results. The Head of Flying Operations suspended the evening Tarlton Springs service pending the outcome of the investigation.

Analysis

Introduction

This analysis examines why SB512's rejected take-off ended 62 m into the runway end safety area, and not on the sealed surface.

The occurrence was the product of two converging threads:

- **The animals on the runway.** Two kangaroos were on runway 09 at the moment the aircraft passed through V1, in darkness, at an aerodrome where no runway inspection had been carried out since the morning.
- **The stop itself.** It began 3 seconds and 6 kt beyond the point assumed in the scheduled accelerate-stop data. It was then flown with reverse thrust available on one engine only.

Both threads met in a single performance shortfall, and that shortfall is the overrun. The analysis follows each factor from where it arose to where it acted on the outcome. It distinguishes the factors that contributed from those that increased risk without contributing, and it sets out one matter that could not be resolved.

People

The decision to reject above V1

The first officer called the kangaroos at 07:30:31, at 116 kt, two seconds after the captain's "V one" call at 112 kt. One second later, at 07:30:32 and 118 kt, the captain called "Stopping. I have control." The flight data showed both power levers reaching flight idle within 0.6 seconds of that call. The whole decision was made and announced in a single exchange, with no discussion and no intervening call.

The decision departed from the operator's procedure. Operations Manual Part B 4.6.4 states: "At or above V1 the take-off shall be continued. The decision to continue is made before V1 is reached."

The captain did not dispute this. In interview and in his air safety report he said he had judged that rotating into two large animals would leave the aircraft airborne at night with damage he could not assess, over country offering no usable option. He described choosing the risk whose end he could see, and he acknowledged plainly that it was not in accordance with the procedure.

The investigation did not treat this as a lapse of knowledge. The captain knew the rule and departed from it deliberately, on the basis of a judgement that continuing was the worse outcome. The context of that judgement is set out under Procedures below:

- Part B 4.6 contains no guidance on an obstruction seen on the runway at any speed.
- The operator's rejected take-off training has never presented one.

That context explains the conditions under which the decision was made. It does not alter what the decision was, and the analysis does not use it to excuse it.

The consequence of the decision is quantifiable:

Quantity	Value
Scheduled accelerate-stop distance required	1,780 m
Accelerate-stop distance available	1,847 m
Scheduled margin	67 m
Aircraft position when reject began	1,152 m along runway 09
Sealed surface remaining	695 m
Stopping distance actually achieved from 118 kt	757 m

The scheduled figure assumes the stop begins at or before V1. Beginning the stop 6 kt and 3 seconds late consumed that 67 m margin and more, before the loss of No. 2 reverse is taken into account.

The investigation found it virtually certain that the take-off was rejected 6 kt above V1, and extremely likely that this contributed to the runway overrun.

The stop once the decision was made

The execution of the stop was considerably better than the operator's own fleet record:

- **Power levers:** at flight idle 0.6 seconds after the decision.
- **Maximum braking:** established at 07:30:34, 2 seconds after the decision, against a recorded fleet mean of 3.2 seconds from decision to maximum braking.
- **Anti-skid:** active on all four wheels throughout.
- **Brakes:** absorbed 84% of the certified maximum energy without a brake fire or hydraulic leak.
- **Reverse:** No. 1 reverse was selected at 07:30:36. The captain's call "Reverse - number two's not coming. Max brakes, max brakes" shows he recognised the loss of No. 2 reverse immediately, without any break in the stopping sequence.
- **Callouts:** the first officer called the decreasing speed and the approaching runway end.

The investigation estimated that a stop begun at the fleet mean response would have carried the aircraft a further 30 to 40 m. That would have taken it close to the far edge of the 90 m runway end safety area, beyond which the terrain is ungraded. As it was, the aircraft left the sealed surface at approximately 21 kt and stopped 62 m into a prepared, graded surface, upright and on the extended centreline, 28 m short of the end of the prepared area.

After the aircraft stopped, the captain:

- confirmed there were no fire indications;
- shut both engines down;
- held the cabin;
- requested activation of the aerodrome emergency plan; and
- elected a controlled disembarkation by the forward airstair rather than an evacuation.

No slides were deployed.

The investigation found it virtually certain that maximum braking and No. 1 reverse were applied without delay, and very likely that this reduced the severity of the overrun.

No runway inspection before departure

No runway inspection was requested before SB512 departed:

- Neither the cockpit voice recorder nor the tower's recorded audio contained any request for an inspection, any offer of one, or any mention of wildlife before departure.
- The aerodrome's daily inspection log recorded one inspection that day, at 07:35 local before the first arrival, with the movement area clear. None followed, and none was requested.

An inspection was available. Aerodrome Manual 6.3 provides for inspections outside the scheduled time at the request of the reporting officer or a pilot in command. The reporting officer confirmed one would have been carried out if asked. It would have cost nothing, and it would have put a vehicle on the runway in the period before the roll.

This omission had no owner in the ordinary sense:

- Both crew said they had not considered an inspection.
- No document asked either of them to. Operations Manual Part A 8.14.3 states that at an aerodrome not listed in Appendix 8A "no specific action is required", and Tarlton Springs was not listed.
- The captain had expected Tarlton Springs to be on the list, and was surprised to find that it was not.
- On the aerodrome side, no wildlife transmission had been made on the tower channel in the 90 minutes before the take-off clearance.

The omission is therefore best understood as the outcome of the listing criterion discussed under Procedures, not as an individual departure from a requirement.

An inspection would have covered the section of runway between 1,050 m and 1,250 m, where the fence pad and both carcasses were found, and aerodrome staff disperse animals when they find them. The investigation discounted this from certainty for one reason: an inspection completed some minutes before the roll cannot guarantee that the runway stays clear until the aircraft passes.

The investigation found it virtually certain that no runway inspection was requested before the first departure after last light, and likely that this contributed to the kangaroos being on the runway when the aircraft reached them.

Crew duty

SB512 was the fifth sector of the crew's duty:

- It had been added that morning, when the rostered crew reported unfit.
- The crew had signed on at 06:30 local, and the occurrence was 11 hours 00 minutes into a duty planned to total 12 hours 05 minutes. The limit for five sectors with that sign-on was 12 hours 30 minutes.
- The service was running 40 minutes late.
- Both crew described themselves in interview as tired but not struggling. The captain said he would have declined a further sector, and that he had been fully engaged during the seconds that mattered.

The investigation examined whether this condition had an effect on the occurrence. The case for it is that 11 hours into a five-sector day falls within the range in which degraded decision-making is expected, on a late schedule with a crew working to finish.

The case against rests on recorded data, and each mechanism by which fatigue would have had to act was contradicted:

- **Response time:** the response from decision to flight idle (0.6 seconds) and to maximum braking (2 seconds) was at the fast end of the fleet distribution.
- **The roll:** no error of omission was identified during the roll.
- **The runway inspection:** the one decision the schedule could plausibly have affected, not requesting an inspection, was never presented to either crew member by any document. Fatigue cannot be found to have caused the omission of a step neither crew member was asked to take.

On that evidence, it was unlikely that the duty affected the occurrence. The condition was nonetheless assessed as important, because it is built into the schedule rather than confined to one day. The evening Tarlton Springs rotation places the last sector inside the final hour of a duty of about 12 hours. It does so at an aerodrome with:

- no company engineering support;
- no alternate within 200 nm at night; and

- no crewing resilience.

Under those conditions a single unfit crew member turns a four-sector day into a five-sector one on the morning of operation.

The investigation found it virtually certain that the flight was the fifth sector, 11 hours into duty and 40 minutes behind schedule. It was unlikely that this contributed to the occurrence, but likely that it increased risk. It is an other factor that increased risk, not a contributing safety factor.

Environment

Darkness at the peak of kangaroo movement

The take-off roll began at 17:30 local:

- 32 minutes after sunset at 16:58;
- 5 minutes after the end of civil twilight at 17:25; and
- more than five hours before moonrise at 22:41, with the moon a waning crescent 14% illuminated.

There was no natural ambient light on the strip and no town lighting within sight. The investigator's site visit at the same time of day on 23 June 2026 confirmed that the unlit graded strip either side of the sealed surface is not visible from the centreline.

The aerodrome's own wildlife sighting log, a paper register covering January 2025 to June 2026, showed why the timing mattered:

- 41 of its 46 entries recorded kangaroos on or adjacent to the movement area.
- 38 of those 41 were timed between one hour before and two hours after last light.
- 11 entries recorded animals on the sealed surface of runway 09/27.

The departure therefore fell inside the window in which the aerodrome's own records show almost all of its kangaroo movement, and in a light condition in which nothing off the sealed surface could be seen.

This is consistent with what the first officer described immediately after the stop. She said the animals "came out of the dark on the left of the strip, crossed the centreline", and that "there was nothing to see and then there were two of them." The animals were not seen until they were on the lit surface, which is a direct consequence of the light condition.

The existence of this condition was qualified only by the nature of the log, a paper register whose completeness cannot be verified. The timing of this departure was itself a consequence of the evening service introduced in 2025, discussed under Organisation. On its own the condition is unremarkable; it is what gave the absence of a runway inspection its significance.

The investigation found it extremely likely that the departure took place in the hour after last light, at the peak of kangaroo movement, and likely that this contributed to the kangaroos being on the runway undetected until the aircraft was past V1.

The kangaroos on the runway

Two adult kangaroos were recovered from runway 09, 1,188 m and 1,221 m from the threshold, on the northern half. The first officer saw them crossing from the northern side to the south, estimated the range at first sight at around 200 m, and called them at 07:30:31.

The investigator's site inspection on 23 June 2026 found:

- a continuous 140 m section of the northern perimeter fence with the bottom two wires separated from the posts; and

- a clear animal pad through it at the 1,050 m mark, on the same side of the runway as, and before, both carcass positions.

The aerodrome's sighting log records animals on the sealed surface of runway 09/27 on 11 previous occasions, all around last light.

The presence and position of the animals were not in doubt. What was not established was the exact route by which they reached the runway. The pad at 1,050 m is the most probable entry point on the physical evidence, but the fence had failed over 140 m, so the crossing point could not be fixed. It is that uncertainty about the route, not about the animals, that qualifies this factor.

The reject and the strike both followed directly from the animals being on the surface.

The investigation found it very likely that two kangaroos entered the runway strip and moved onto the sealed surface by way of the failed northern fence, and extremely likely that their presence contributed to the occurrence.

Runway edge lighting intensity: an unresolved matter

The investigation examined whether the intensity of the runway edge lighting reduced the crew's ability to detect the animals. The matter could not be settled.

Evidence in support. Two strands supported the possibility:

- **The captain's account.** He described the lighting as brighter than he would have wanted: a corridor of light with everything outside it black. He said anything off the sealed surface could not be seen coming.
- **The photometric check.** A check on 25 June 2026, carried out at the investigator's request, measured four northern edge lights between the 900 m and 1,200 m markers at between 118% and 131% of nominal intensity for stage 3. That is the section the animals crossed; the remaining lights were within tolerance. The aerodrome's maintenance programme checks lamp serviceability but does not measure intensity, so the deviation would not have been detected in the normal course.

Evidence against. Four points weighed the other way:

- **The first officer's account.** She was the crew member who actually saw the animals. She described the lighting as normal and said she saw the animals completely clearly once they were on the sealed surface, at around 200 m. She also said that, with only two daylight landings at Tarlton Springs to compare against, she was not well placed to judge whether the lighting was unusual.
- **The captain's role after V1.** He had stated on the flight deck that he was "heads-in on the engine page after V one", which is where the procedure puts him. His not seeing the animals therefore has an explanation that does not require the lighting at all.
- **Timing of the measurement.** No measurement exists of the lights' output on the night; the only measurement was made seven days later.
- **No established link.** Nothing establishes a connection between an edge light at up to 131% of nominal and the detection of an object on the runway.

The two crew accounts do not agree, and there is no basis on which to prefer one over the other. The measured deviation is real and in the right place, but it shows a deviation, not an effect on detection.

Resolving the question would require two things the evidence does not contain:

- a measurement of the edge lighting as it was on the night; and

- a basis for relating the measured intensity to the detectability of an animal on the sealed surface.

The investigation assessed it as about as likely as not that the lighting condition existed in a form capable of affecting detection. The matter remains unresolved, and it is not a finding either way.

Equipment

The strike and the loss of No. 2 reverse

The aircraft struck both animals at 07:30:33, at 114 kt, one second after the reject began. The flight data recorded a lateral acceleration spike of 0.31 g to the right and a vertical spike of 1.48 g. The cockpit voice recorder captured a sound consistent with a heavy impact, lasting about 0.4 seconds, followed by airframe rumble.

The post-occurrence inspection found:

- **No. 2 propeller:** three blades damaged beyond repairable limits, with leading edge deformation and one blade tip separation. Animal tissue was recovered from two blade roots.
- **Right main gear:** doors distorted by the impact.
- **Fuselage:** the lower right skin was abraded and punctured in two places by propeller debris.

The recorded data, the physical damage and the recovered tissue were all consistent with one another.

The significance of the strike lay in what it did to the stop, not in the damage itself:

- No. 2 propeller RPM decayed from 07:30:33, consistent with the blade damage.
- When reverse was selected at 07:30:36, the No. 2 reverse interlock did not make, and reverse was obtained on No. 1 only.

The strike therefore removed half of the available reverse thrust two seconds into a stop that, as described above, had already been begun beyond the point the scheduled figures assume and had no margin left to absorb the loss.

The investigation found it virtually certain that the No. 2 propeller and right main gear struck the two kangaroos, and virtually certain that the strike contributed to the overrun through the loss of No. 2 reverse.

Deceleration below the scheduled accelerate-stop performance

The scheduled accelerate-stop data assumes two things:

- that the stop begins at or before V1; and
- that reverse thrust is symmetric.

Neither held on this occasion. Between 07:30:34 and 07:30:44 the mean deceleration was 2.6 m/s², approximately 15% below the value used in the certified accelerate-stop data for this weight and runway condition. When the aircraft left the sealed surface at 07:30:51, deceleration in the graded gravel fell to 1.9 m/s².

The deceleration was not reduced by any failure of the braking system:

- Brake pressure was held at 2,940 psi from 07:30:34 until the aircraft stopped.
- Anti-skid was active on all four wheels, and the system tested serviceable after the occurrence.

- Both right main tyres deflated through their fuse plugs, consistent with the brake energy absorbed.

The shortfall is attributable to the asymmetric reverse that followed the strike.

This is the point at which the two threads of the occurrence converge:

- the late start of the stop, a consequence of the reject decision; and
- the reduced deceleration, a consequence of the strike.

The stopping distance actually achieved from 118 kt was 757 m, against 695 m of sealed surface remaining. The difference is the 62 m overrun. The recorded data, the distance reconstruction from groundspeed, and the continuous tyre marks from 1,160 m to the runway end were all consistent with one another.

The investigation treated the shortfall as a single mechanism. [NOT ESTABLISHED: the separate stopping distance attributable to the late start of the stop and to the reduced deceleration, and whether either alone would have taken the aircraft beyond the runway end.]

The investigation found it virtually certain that the deceleration achieved was below the scheduled accelerate-stop performance, and virtually certain that this shortfall contributed to the runway overrun.

Cabin floor proximity emergency lighting

During the disembarkation, the first officer noticed sections of the aisle floor strip unlit while walking back through the cabin. A functional check on 24 June 2026 found that, with the emergency lighting system armed and the aircraft on battery power:

- two of the six floor proximity escape path segments, on the left side aft of row 16, did not illuminate; and
- the fault traced to a failed ballast common to both segments.

The defect could not have been detected in normal operations:

- The pre-flight emergency lighting test on this type illuminates the ceiling emergency lights and exit signs, but neither illuminates nor monitors the floor proximity segments.
- Neither the crew nor a line engineer could have found the fault without a dedicated functional test.
- The last such test was 11 months before the occurrence, inside the maintenance programme's 24-month interval.

The defect had no bearing on the overrun or its outcome:

- No evacuation was commanded.
- The main cabin lights were on throughout.
- The disembarkation by the forward airstair was unhurried and was completed 4 minutes 8 seconds after the aircraft stopped, without incident.

On that basis it was unlikely that the defect influenced the occurrence.

It was nonetheless assessed as important, for three reasons:

- **The consequences in a different outcome.** Had there been a fire indication, smoke, or a night evacuation over the wing, two dark segments in the aft cabin could have been the difference between an orderly exit and a blocked one.
- **The monitoring gap.** A 24-month interval on a system the daily test cannot see means the true state of the fleet's floor proximity lighting is unknown.
- **The fleet exposure.** The same ballast is fitted across the type.

[NOT ESTABLISHED: the serviceability of the same ballast and floor proximity segments across the remainder of the fleet.]

The investigation found it virtually certain that the cabin floor proximity emergency lighting was partially unserviceable. It was unlikely that this contributed to the occurrence, but very likely that it increased risk. It is an other factor that increased risk, not a contributing safety factor.

Procedures

The runway inspection requirement and its listing criterion

The operator's own defence against wildlife on the runway at night is set out in Operations Manual Part A 8.14.2:

- "At an aerodrome listed in Appendix 8A, the pilot in command shall request a runway inspection from the aerodrome operator prior to the first departure after last light, and shall not commence the take-off roll until the result of that inspection has been passed."

Had that requirement applied at Tarlton Springs, it would have produced the inspection whose absence is discussed under People. The control itself is sound.

The difficulty lies in how an aerodrome comes to be listed. Appendix 8A states:

- "An aerodrome is listed in this appendix where a wildlife strike involving a company aircraft has been reported at that aerodrome within the preceding 24 months."

The list's operation is limited in several ways:

- It is reviewed annually, and was last reviewed on 3 March 2025, four months before the evening service began.
- On 18 June 2026 it listed nine aerodromes. Tarlton Springs was not among them and had never been listed.
- No provision in Part A asks a crew to report a wildlife sighting.
- No provision admits an aerodrome to the list on any evidence other than a reported strike.

The effect is that the control is triggered only by the outcome it exists to prevent. Tarlton Springs had had no company strike, so it could not be listed. Because it was not listed, 8.14.3 applied and no inspection was requested. Because no inspection was requested, nothing was looked for.

The information that would have justified listing existed, but it could not reach the operator by any route the procedure recognised. The aerodrome's paper sighting log records 11 occasions on which kangaroos were on the sealed surface of runway 09/27. The log was not reported to any operator, and the aerodrome reporting officer confirmed that no airline had ever asked for it. Those sightings were not strikes, and they could not put the aerodrome on the list.

The investigation allowed some discount from certainty in the effect of this factor, for the same reason as for the omitted inspection: an inspection completed some minutes before departure does not guarantee a clear runway at the roll.

The investigation found it virtually certain that the operator's runway inspection requirement applied only at listed aerodromes and that the only listing criterion was a reported strike, and very likely that this contributed to no inspection being requested before SB512 departed.

Rejected take-off guidance and training

Operations Manual Part B 4.6 sets out the operator's rejected take-off criteria:

- **Below 80 kt:** the take-off is to be rejected for any condition that makes the aircraft unfit to fly.
- **Between 80 kt and V1:** it is to be rejected only for fire, engine failure, a configuration warning, loss of directional control, or the pilot in command's judgement that the aircraft is unsafe or unable to fly.
- **At or above V1:** it is to be continued.

The section contains no guidance on an obstruction seen on the runway, at any speed. It also offers no amplification of 4.6.4 for a case in which continuing is itself hazardous.

Recurrent training syllabus TRG-SYL-07, module 4, reflects the same scope. Its stated objective is for the crew to demonstrate:

- "a correctly executed rejected take-off for an engine failure, an engine fire and a configuration warning, each initiated below V1, and will demonstrate the decision to continue for a failure recognised at or after V1."

Its four scripted simulator scenarios are:

- engine failure at 90 kt;
- engine fire at 100 kt;
- configuration warning at 85 kt; and
- engine failure at V1 plus 5 kt, continued.

Every scenario is an aircraft system event, and three are below V1. The company's records show that 214 crew completed module 4 in the 2025 to 2026 cycle. No crew had been presented with an external obstruction scenario in the five training cycles held on file; records beyond those five cycles were not available.

Both the captain and the first officer raised this independently and without prompting, in almost the same terms. Each said that every stop or go scenario they had been given had been an engine event arriving below V1.

The investigation considered two readings of how this bore on the decision to reject.

The first reading. The captain had about two seconds and nothing behind him. The decision he made was the first time he had considered the question at all, and preventing exactly that is the purpose of a training system. On this reading, an unrehearsed decision made cold in two seconds is not the same decision as one made against a briefed and practised frame.

The second reading. The captain knew the rule and departed from it deliberately, not through unawareness. Training on obstructions would not have changed what he knew: he rejected because he judged the alternative worse, not because he was untrained. On this reading, the training gap is a finding about the fleet, not a cause of this reject.

The investigation accepted the first reading on the balance of the evidence, but did not treat the second as disposed of. Both readings should be carried: the absence of training explains the conditions in which the decision was made, and does not excuse it.

The investigation found it extremely likely that the operator's rejected take-off guidance and training addressed aircraft system failures and did not address an obstruction on the runway at any speed, and likely that this contributed to the take-off being rejected above V1.

Organisation

Introduction of the evening service

The operator's current route risk assessment for Tarlton Springs, RRA-041 issue 3 of November 2022, carries the operating restriction: "daylight operations only pending review of night lighting and diversion fuel policy." No issue 4 exists.

Change Management Record CMR-2025-118 introduced an evening rotation from 14 July 2025, six days per week. It was the first scheduled company operation into Tarlton Springs after last light. The record:

- assessed the change as "schedule change only";
- listed "Existing aerodrome, existing aircraft type, existing crew qualifications, existing engineering support arrangements";
- recorded "No new hazard identified"; and
- answered "No" to "Route risk assessment review required".

It was approved by the Head of Flying Operations on 22 May 2025.

The daylight-only restriction in RRA-041 is not referenced anywhere in CMR-2025-118, and RRA-041 was not reopened. The Safety Department's records show no involvement in the change beyond receipt of the approved record.

The change process asked whether the change was new. It did not ask whether the existing assessment still held for the operation being introduced. As a result, a company aircraft was scheduled into the aerodrome after last light in direct contradiction of a live restriction in the operator's own current documentation.

The existence of this factor was qualified only by the absence of an interview with the approver, who has since left the company. Both documents are current controlled copies.

A review of RRA-041 against a night operation would have reached the aerodrome's wildlife exposure and the Appendix 8A listing in the same pass. That is not certain, because such a review might have addressed lighting and diversion fuel alone, which are the only matters the restriction names. The evening service also created the operation that placed SB512 at Tarlton Springs in the hour after last light, discussed under Environment.

The investigation found it extremely likely that the evening service was approved as a schedule change without the route risk assessment being reopened, and likely that this contributed to the runway inspection requirement not being applied at Tarlton Springs.

Deferral of the perimeter fence repair

The failure of the northern perimeter fence was documented in the aerodrome works register, held by Tarlton Shire Council:

- **April 2023:** item WR-221 recorded four displaced panels and strained wire on the northern boundary between the 700 m and 1,300 m runway markers, with animals observed passing through. It recommended replacement, at an estimated \$41,000.
- **2023, 2024 and 2025:** the item was deferred at each budget round, each time as unfunded and for review in the next cycle.
- **February 2026:** item WR-263 recorded the same section as deteriorating further.

By the investigator's site inspection on 23 June 2026, the breach had become a continuous 140 m section with the bottom two wires separated from the posts. A clear animal pad ran through it at the 1,050 m mark, on the same side of the runway as the carcasses recovered at 1,188 m and 1,221 m.

Nothing here had to be reconstructed. The condition and its deferrals are recorded in the aerodrome operator's own register, including the observation in the original 2023 entry that animals were passing through.

A fence in the condition found does not exclude kangaroos, and the pad through the breach lies directly upstream of the strike position. The one qualification, discussed under Environment, is that the exact crossing point within the 140 m failed section could not be fixed. Of the factors examined, this is the only one that a single, costed works item would have addressed directly.

The investigation found it virtually certain that the perimeter fence repair was deferred for three budget cycles, and very likely that this contributed to the kangaroos reaching the runway.

The aerodrome standard's documentation threshold

Aerodrome Standard AS-139 section 10.4 sets the wildlife management obligation in two tiers:

- **All certified aerodromes (10.4.1):** the operator "must take reasonable measures to reduce the risk to aircraft operations presented by wildlife on or in the vicinity of the aerodrome."
- **Larger aerodromes (10.4.2):** a documented wildlife hazard management plan is required only where the aerodrome "is used by aeroplanes having a maximum take-off weight exceeding 27,000 kg, or serves more than 350,000 passenger movements in a calendar year."
- **Aerodromes below that threshold (10.4.3):** measures "need not be documented, but the aerodrome operator must be able to demonstrate what measures are in place."

Tarlton Springs fell below both limbs of 10.4.2. Its heaviest scheduled aeroplane is the 22,900 kg twin-turboprop used on the Saltbush Air service, and it handled 61,400 passenger movements in 2025. Accordingly the aerodrome held:

- no wildlife hazard management plan;
- no hazard assessment;
- no dispersal programme; and
- no record of measures beyond the single pre-first-arrival inspection at Aerodrome Manual 6.3.

This was confirmed against the certified aerodrome register and the aerodrome operator's compliance file. The aerodrome was not in breach of the standard. The factor is therefore an external influence arising from where the standard draws its line, not a compliance matter.

Case for influence. The absence of a documented plan was the absence of the one mechanism that would have done two things:

- connected the aerodrome's sighting log to the operators using the aerodrome; and
- placed the failed fence on a funded programme rather than an unfunded works register.

A documented plan brings an audit trail and an owner, and every other control in this occurrence failed for want of exactly those.

Case against. Three points weighed against:

- 10.4.1 still obliged the aerodrome operator to take reasonable measures.
- A documented plan is not the only way to repair a fence or pass a sighting log to an airline.
- The deferrals were budget decisions, and there is no evidence that a documented plan would have been funded any better.

The investigation accepted influence on the balance of the evidence. Its confidence in this link is lower than for the other contributing factors, and the finding should be read as such, not as settled.

The investigation found it virtually certain that AS-139 required a documented wildlife hazard management plan only above a size threshold that Tarlton Springs does not meet, and likely that this contributed to the occurrence through the unfunded fence repair and the absence of any route for the aerodrome's wildlife information to reach the operator.

Hypotheses tested and excluded

Two further hypotheses were tested and ruled out.

A tailwind above limits. A take-off with a tailwind above limits was considered because an overrun of this distance invites the question. It was excluded on two independent sources, which agreed:

- The 06:30, 07:00 and 08:00 UTC observations gave winds of 090 at 7, 6 and 5 kt respectively, a headwind component of 5 to 7 kt on runway 09.
- The recorded wind at the aircraft gave a headwind component of 4 to 6 kt throughout the roll, with no tailwind component at any point.

The crew's performance calculation used a 5 kt headwind, which matched. It was very unlikely that a tailwind existed.

A No. 2 engine power loss before the reject. A power loss on the No. 2 engine during the take-off roll was considered because a high-speed reject is most commonly an engine event. It was excluded:

- The flight data recorded both engines at 98.4% and 98.5% torque, within 0.1% of each other, from power set until the power levers were retarded at 07:30:32.
- Fuel flow, ITT and propeller RPM on both engines were within normal scatter, and no caution, warning or exceedance was recorded before the reject.
- The cockpit voice recorder contained no engine-related call. The captain's first words after the first officer's sighting call were "Stopping. I have control."
- The borescope of both engines found no pre-existing damage.
- The No. 2 propeller damage and RPM decay both began at 07:30:33, after the reject and at the moment of impact. The loss of No. 2 was a consequence of the strike, not a cause of the reject.

It was very unlikely that a No. 2 engine power loss occurred before the reject.

Findings summary

Contributing safety factors

- A documented wildlife plan was required only above a size threshold that Tarlton Springs Aerodrome did not meet. This virtually certain existed and likely contributed. (Safety Issue)
- The repair of the aerodrome's northern perimeter fence was deferred for three budget cycles. This virtually certain existed and very likely contributed. (Safety Issue)
- Two kangaroos entered the runway strip and moved onto the sealed surface of runway 09. This very likely existed and very likely contributed.
- The take-off was rejected at 118 kt, 6 kt above V1. This virtually certain existed and very likely contributed.
- The deceleration achieved during the rejected take-off was below the scheduled accelerate-stop performance. This virtually certain existed and virtually certain contributed.
- The departure took place in the hour after last light, which was the peak of kangaroo movement at the aerodrome. This very likely existed and likely contributed.
- The operator required a runway inspection before the first departure after last light only at aerodromes listed in Appendix 8A, and the only criterion for listing an aerodrome was a reported wildlife strike. This virtually certain existed and very likely contributed. (Safety Issue)
- No runway inspection was requested before the first departure after last light. This virtually certain existed and likely contributed.
- The evening service was approved as a schedule change, and the route risk assessment for Tarlton Springs was not reopened. This very likely existed and likely contributed. (Safety Issue)
- Rejected take-off training covered only aircraft system failures below V1. This very likely existed and likely contributed. (Safety Issue)
- The No. 2 propeller and the right main landing gear struck two kangaroos. This virtually certain existed and virtually certain contributed.

Other factors that increased risk

- Two of the six cabin floor proximity emergency lighting segments aft of row 16 on the left side were unserviceable. This virtually certain existed and very likely increased risk. (Safety Issue)
- SB512 was the fifth sector of the flight crew's duty, 11 hours into that duty and 40 minutes behind schedule. This virtually certain existed and likely increased risk.

Other findings

- The hypothesis that the take-off began with a tailwind above limits was examined and ruled out.
- The hypothesis that the No. 2 engine lost power during the take-off roll was examined and ruled out.
- Maximum braking and No. 1 reverse were applied without delay, and this was examined and found to reduce risk.

Appendices

Appendix A - Test summary

The table below sets out, for each factor analysed, the area of the investigation it fell within, the result of each test applied to it, and the category that followed. A factor is a contributing safety factor only if it passed both the existence and influence tests. It is an other factor that increased risk if it failed the influence test but passed the importance test. The likelihood term shown against each result is the one assigned when the test was applied.

Factor	Lane	Existence	Influence	Importance	Category
Documented wildlife plan required only above a size threshold the aerodrome does not meet	External Influences	Pass – virtually certain	Pass – likely	Not tested	Contributing safety factor (safety issue)
Perimeter fence repair deferred for three budget cycles	Organisational Influences	Pass – virtually certain	Pass – very likely	Not tested	Contributing safety factor (safety issue)
Evening service approved as a schedule change, route risk assessment not reopened	Organisational Influences	Pass – extremely likely	Pass – likely	Not tested	Contributing safety factor (safety issue)
Runway inspection required only at listed aerodromes, and the listing criterion is a strike	Risk Controls	Pass – virtually certain	Pass – very likely	Not tested	Contributing safety factor (safety issue)
Rejected take-off training covers aircraft system failures below V1 only	Risk Controls	Pass – extremely likely	Pass – likely	Not tested	Contributing safety factor (safety issue)
Departure in the hour after last light, the peak of kangaroo movement	Local Conditions	Pass – extremely likely	Pass – likely	Not tested	Contributing safety factor
No runway inspection requested before the first departure after last light	Individual Actions	Pass – virtually certain	Pass – likely	Not tested	Contributing safety factor
Take-off rejected 6 kt above V1	Individual Actions	Pass – virtually certain	Pass – extremely likely	Not tested	Contributing safety factor
Two kangaroos entered the runway strip and moved onto the sealed surface	Occurrence Events	Pass – very likely	Pass – extremely likely	Not tested	Contributing safety factor
No. 2 propeller and right main gear struck two kangaroos	Occurrence Events	Pass – virtually certain	Pass – virtually certain	Not tested	Contributing safety factor
Deceleration achieved below the scheduled	Occurrence Events	Pass – virtually certain	Pass – virtually certain	Not tested	Contributing safety factor

accelerate-stop performance					
Cabin floor proximity emergency lighting partially unserviceable	Risk Controls	Pass – virtually certain	Fail – unlikely	Pass – very likely	Other factor that increased risk (safety issue)
Fifth sector, 11 hours into duty, 40 minutes behind schedule	Local Conditions	Pass – virtually certain	Fail – unlikely	Pass – likely	Other factor that increased risk
Maximum braking and No. 1 reverse applied without delay	Individual Actions	Pass – virtually certain	Pass – very likely (decrease in risk)	Not tested	Positive factor
Take-off commenced with a tailwind above limits	Local Conditions	Fail – very unlikely	Not tested	Not tested	Excluded
No. 2 engine power loss during the take-off roll	Occurrence Events	Fail – very unlikely	Not tested	Not tested	Excluded
Runway edge lighting intensity reduced the crew's ability to detect the animals	Local Conditions	Inconclusive – about as likely as not	Not tested	Not tested	Unresolved; not a finding

The runway edge lighting matter was examined and could not be settled. The photometric check on 25/06/2026 measured four northern edge lights between the 900 m and 1,200 m markers at 118% to 131% of nominal for stage 3, in the section the animals crossed. That check was made seven days after the occurrence. No measurement exists of the lighting on the night, and nothing established a link between the measured intensity and detection of an object on the runway. The two flight crew accounts of the lighting did not agree. The captain's non-detection has an explanation that does not depend on the lighting, because the procedure placed him heads-in on the engine page after V1. A measurement of the lighting as it was on the night, together with evidence of its effect on detection, would be needed to resolve the matter. Neither is available.

Appendix B - Excluded hypotheses

Take-off commenced with a tailwind above limits

This hypothesis was tested because the aircraft stopped 62 m beyond the end of the runway. It was ruled out. The aerodrome observations at 06:30, 07:00 and 08:00 UTC gave 090 at 7 kt, 090 at 6 kt and 090 at 5 kt, a headwind component of 5 to 7 kt on runway 09. The recorded FDR wind during the roll gave a headwind component of 4 to 6 kt throughout, with no tailwind component at any point. The crew's performance entry used a 5 kt headwind, which matched both sources. No source provided any evidence of a tailwind at any stage of the roll.

No. 2 engine power loss during the take-off roll

This hypothesis was tested because a rejected take-off at 118 kt is most commonly associated with an engine event. It was ruled out on the following evidence:

- **Engine parameters:** the FDR recorded both engines at 98.4% and 98.5% torque, within 0.1% of each other, from power set at 07:30:02 until the power levers were retarded at 07:30:32. Fuel flow, ITT and propeller RPM on both engines stayed within normal scatter throughout.
- **Alerts:** no caution, warning or exceedance was recorded at any point before the reject.

- **Cockpit audio:** the CVR contained no engine-related call. The captain's first words, "Stopping, I have control", came one second after the first officer's sighting call.
- **Physical inspection:** the borescope inspection of both engines found no pre-existing damage.
- **Timing:** the No. 2 propeller damage and the RPM decay both began at 07:30:33, after the reject and at the moment of impact.

The loss of No. 2 was therefore a consequence of the strike and not a cause of the reject.

Appendix C - Sources of evidence

Interviews and accounts

- **Captain (pilot in command):** interview recorded and transcribed. Interviews with both flight crew were completed by 26 June 2026. The captain also submitted an air safety report.
- **First officer:** interview recorded and transcribed, completed by 26 June 2026.
- **Aerodrome reporting officer:** during the site visit on 23 June 2026, confirmed that no operator had ever asked for the wildlife sighting log. The reporting officer also confirmed that a runway inspection would have been carried out on 18 June 2026 if one had been requested.
- **Approver of CMR-2025-118:** no interview was obtained. The approver has since left the company.

Recorded data and audio

- Flight Data Section report FDA-2026-0417-R1, FDR and QAR readout, VH-SBQ, sector SB512, issued 24/06/2026
- CVR-2026-0417, tower audio and CVR transcript, 07:29 to 07:34 UTC, transcribed 25/06/2026 and verified by a second investigator

Aircraft and site examination

- Engineering inspection report, VH-SBQ, post-occurrence aircraft inspection and runway survey, 19/06/2026 to 21/06/2026, including the borescope inspection of both engines
- Functional check record, VH-SBQ cabin emergency lighting, 24/06/2026
- Photometric check, Tarlton Springs runway 09/27 edge lighting, 25/06/2026
- Site inspection of the northern perimeter fence and photographs of the site, damage and environment, 23/06/2026

Weather and environment

- MET-ARCH-SB512-180626, weather observations, forecast, and light and moon data, retrieved 19/06/2026

Aerodrome documentation

- Tarlton Springs Aerodrome wildlife sighting log, 01/2025 to 06/2026, copied 23/06/2026
- Tarlton Shire Council aerodrome works register, items WR-221 (04/2023) and WR-263 (02/2026)
- Aerodrome daily inspection log, 18/06/2026
- Aerodrome Manual 6.3
- Certified aerodrome register and the aerodrome operator's compliance file

Operator documentation

- Saltbush Air Operations Manual Part A section 8.14, revision 9, 04/2024, and Appendix 8A

- Saltbush Air Operations Manual Part B section 4.6, revision 14, 09/2025
- Recurrent training syllabus TRG-SYL-07, cycle 2025 to 2026, module 4
- Route Risk Assessment RRA-041, issue 3 (11/2022)
- Change Management Record CMR-2025-118 (approved 22/05/2025)
- Flight crew records and duty record, 18/06/2026

Regulatory material

- Aerodrome Standard AS-139, section 10.4, wildlife hazard management

Other

- Drug and alcohol test results for both flight crew

Appendix D - Investigation activity

- **18 June 2026:** the investigation was notified by the Duty Operations Controller with a risk rating of High. The investigation was opened, terms of reference were requested and the investigation folder was created.
- **19 June 2026:** the recorders were removed at Tarlton Springs and dispatched to the flight data section. Both flight crew were stood down and tested, with negative results. The Head of Flying Operations suspended the evening Tarlton Springs service.
- **23 June 2026:** the investigation visited Tarlton Springs. The northern fence was walked and photographed, and a continuous 140 m failure and an animal pad at the 1,050 m mark were found. The wildlife sighting log was copied and a photometric check of the runway 09/27 edge lighting was requested. The reporting officer confirmed that no operator had ever asked for the sighting log.
- **26 June 2026:** interviews with the pilot in command and the first officer had been completed and recorded. A functional check of the cabin emergency lighting was raised from the first officer's account.
- **2 July 2026:** the Appendix 8A listing criterion was confirmed as self-referential. Only a reported strike at an aerodrome could list it, and no provision asked a crew to report a sighting. The matter was raised with the Safety Department.

Distribution

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